



In a bid to save on air conditioning, Japanese executives no longer wear ties and suits to formal meetings. With India's climate being described as hot, hotter and hottest, it's probably time to ban Western wear for men. Instead, the traditional *lungi* that Harvard-educated Finance Minister P. Chidambaram adorns could be an ideal wear for south India. North Indian men can choose from their alternatives.

Greenbacks

Putting in place climate change mitigation and adaptation measures is a costly business. Adaptation means taking steps to minimise adverse impacts like relocating people from an eroding seashore. Mitigation involves reduction of GHG emissions by switching to renewables. India should play a leading role in getting developed countries to finance such projects.

Our & D

Technology holds the key to combating climate change. The search is on for breakthrough technology in all sectors that cause major emissions. Instead of going out with a begging bowl for technology, India should enter into joint ventures with researchers doing cutting-edge research on climate change anywhere in the world. That would get Indian scientists and technologists the requisite know how with which they can come up with their own innovative solutions and even earn money.



Walk, Don't Drive

With petrol prices galloping, it's time to abandon those leisurely car drives to pick up paan or potato chips from the neighbourhood grocery store. Walking a km or more would not only save you



money but help you cut the flab around your waist. Even if you plan to take your vehicle, do make sure you combine the trip with a whole lot of other pending jobs to make optimum use of the fuel burnt.

Saving Rivers

The condition of India's rivers is a barometer of the state of the environment. One look at most of them and you know that the rivers are dying. Most are highly polluted with domestic sewage, industrial effluents and an erratic waterflow. With global warming, the stress levels on the country's key rivers will only exacerbate. Both, the Centre and the states will have to launch serious drives to revive the ecosystems. Right now it's left to divine intervention.

No Free Rides

The Indian power sector has one of the highest transmission losses of around a third of the power generated and yet it is blissfully unconcerned. Theft is rampant as is corruption. With most states promising free power to farmers, there is scant respect for the way electricity is used or misused. Unless power is priced appropriately, inefficient use and pilferage will continue. It's time to bring fiscal discipline into the sector.



40

Himalayan Task

With evidence of rapidly-shrinking glaciers, the entire Himalayan eco-system is imperilled. That includes perennial rivers such as Indus, Ganga and the Brahmaputra which may experience floods at first and then a poor water flow. With 45 million people becoming vulnerable to the impact of climate change, urgent measures need to be taken to prevent erosion, land degradation and the rapid rate of recession of glaciers.